

dramatic act. He had gathered around him a group of followers who shared his hatred of the president, and over a period of months they had discussed various ways of doing him harm.



The assassination

A print captures the moment that John Wilkes Booth fired the fatal shot. Taking no chances, the assassin holds a knife as he takes aim at President Lincoln's head.

The plot takes shape

News of Lee's surrender at Appomattox brought matters to a head. The day before, Booth had heard Lincoln give an impromptu speech from a window of the White House, in which the president gave his support to the enfranchisement of Black voters. For Booth, who was